



Mail Merging

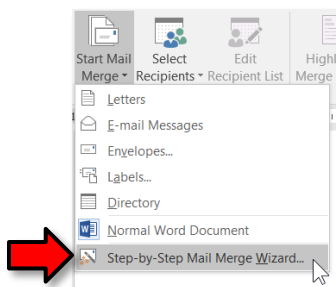
Mail merge is a feature of Word processing programs that enables you to generate form letters. Form letters are sent out en masse to people where much of the letter is the same for each recipient. What changes in the letter are the recipient's name, address, and maybe certain other items specific to each recipient.

To use a mail-merge system, you would first create a **data file** with a set of information, like a list of names and addresses. In a Word document, you would create a **sample letter**, substituting special symbols in place of names and addresses (or whatever other information will come from the first file). Through a series of small steps, you can create form letters that are personalized for each recipient.

The data file can be created with various programs such as Word, Excel, or Access. The beauty of the mail merge feature is that, while you can create your own data source in Word, if you already have a spreadsheet of data created in Excel or some other program, it makes sense to use that.

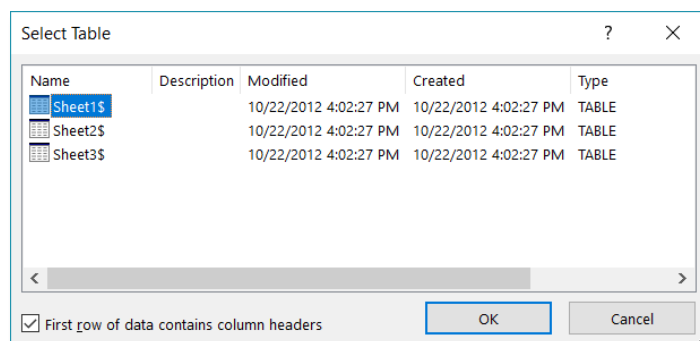
Steps to Create a Mail Merge Document

1. To save time, we have already created a data file in Excel and a sample letter in Word and placed them on your flash drive.
 - a. **Insert** your flash drive.
 - b. **Use File Explorer** to **open** Donations List.xlsx.
 - c. **Use File Explorer** to **open** merge letter.docx.
2. Before we start the mail merge process, let's look at the donations list that was created in Excel.
 - a. **Notice** that the **list** is on the worksheet named Sheet 1.
 - b. Notice that the **first row** of the worksheet contains headings.
 - c. **Close** Donations List.xlsx
3. In **merge letter.docx**, **notice** that the **address** of the establishment, the **body** of the letter and the **closing** are all in place. We will use mail merge to personalize each letter with an **address block**, a **salutation**, and a **donation** amount for each person in our list.
4. **Click** the **Mailings** tab.
5. **Find** the **Start Mail Merge** group. **Click** **Start Mail Merge** and then **click** **Step-by-Step Mail Merge Wizard**.



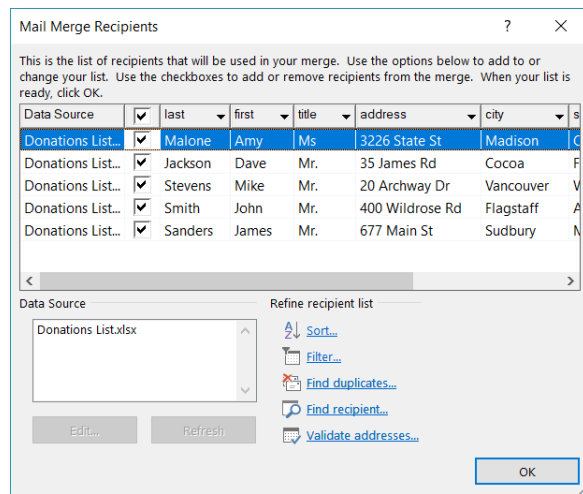


6. A **Mail Merge** pane will open on the right that will take you through the mail merge process in 6 steps.
7. **Step 1 - Notice** **Select document type** prompt. By default, the radio button for letters is checked, which is what we want. **Click** on **Next: Starting Document** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
8. **Step 2 - Notice** the **Select starting document** prompt. Since we will be using this letter, do not change the default selection of use the current document. **Click** on **Next: Select Recipients** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
9. **Step 3 - Notice** the **Select recipients** prompt
 - a. The default selection, Use an existing list is the one we need. To find the list, **click** on the Browse button.
 - b. A **Select Data Source** dialogue box will open. **Navigate** to your flash drive and **open** **Donations List.xlsx**
 - c. A **Select Table** dialogue box will open. We need to provide some information about our document.
 - i. **Notice** that by default, Sheet 1 is selected.
 - ii. **Remember** that when we examined our Excel file our data was on the Worksheet entitled Sheet 1.
 - iii. Also **be sure** that the **check box** before First row of data contains column headers is **checked**.
 - iv. **Click** **OK**.

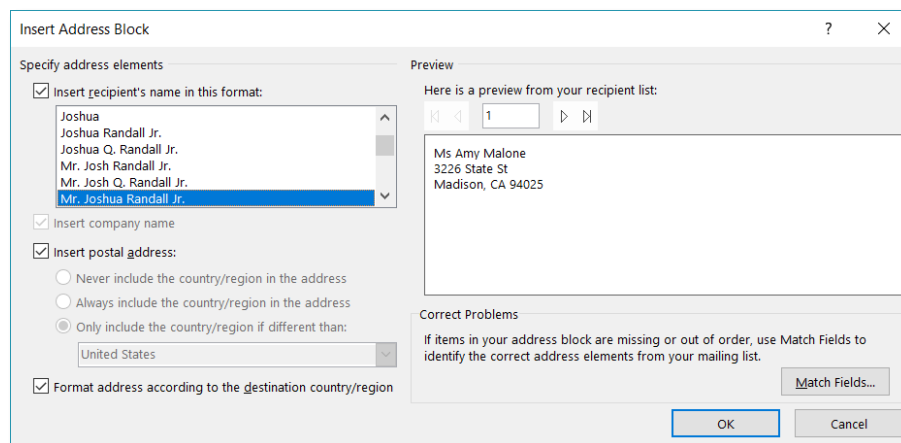




- d. A **Mail Merge Recipients** dialogue box will open which will allow you to review, delete or change your list. Since we are not making any changes, **click OK**.



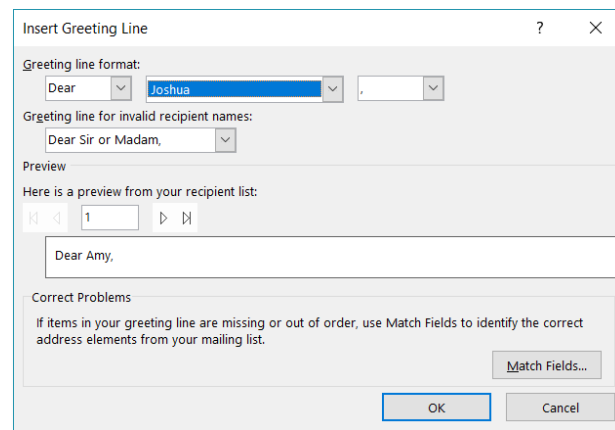
- e. **Click Next: Write your letter** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
10. **Step 4 - Notice** the **Write your letter** prompt. Since we are using an existing letter, we merely have to click into a location within the letter to insert different items.
- a. **Place** your insertion point below the return address for the Animal Shelter, then **click Address block** in the Mail Merge pane.
- b. An **Insert Address Block** Dialogue box will appear with a **preview** of how your address block will look in the letter. If you select a different format, your preview will change. Make no changes. **Click OK**.



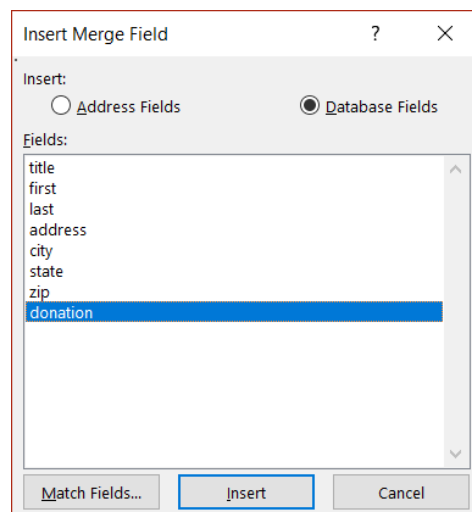
- c. **Notice** how the text **«AddressBlock»** has appeared. This will be replaced with an actual address when we complete the mail merge.
- d. **Place** your insertion point below the address block and **click Greeting Line** in the Mail Merge Pane.



- e. An **Insert Greeting Line** dialogue box will appear to allow you to control the way you want your greeting to appear.
 - i. **Click** on the **list arrow** next to the box that reads “Mr . Randall” and **click** “Joshua”. This will use the person’s first name as the greeting.
 - ii. **Click OK**.



- f. Within the body of the letter, **place** your insertion point immediately after the words **contribution of** in the first sentence. **Click** on **More items** in the Mail Merge pane.
- g. An **Insert Merge Field** dialogue box will appear.
 - i. **Click donation**
 - ii. **Click Insert**.
 - iii. **Click Close**.

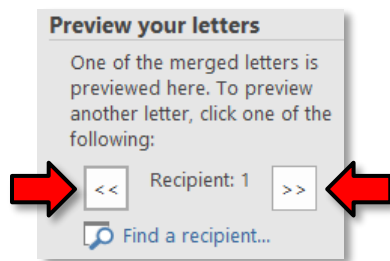


- h. **Be sure** that there is a space before and after «**donation**».
- i. **Click Next: Preview your letters** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.



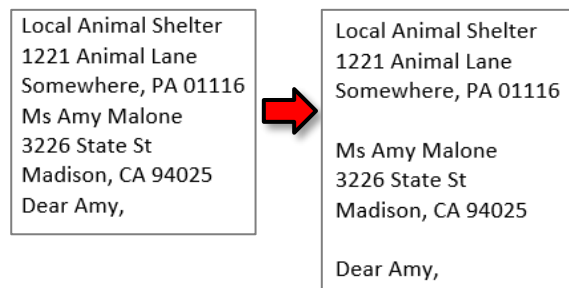
11. **Step 5** – **Notice** the **Preview your letters** prompt.

- a. The letter to the first person on your list will appear.
- b. **Use** the **arrows** to **scroll** through each succeeding letter.



- c. **Notice** how the addresses and greeting are all clumped together. Let's insert some blank lines to separate them. Even though only one person's letter is showing, these changes will affect each letter.

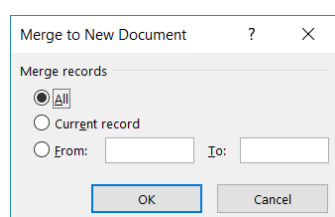
- i. **Click** at the end of the **first zip code** of the first address and press **Enter**.
- ii. **Click** after the **second zip code** and press **Enter**.



- d. **Notice** that there is no \$ before the donation amount in your letter. **Place** your insertion point directly before the donation amount, and **type** a \$. This change will affect each letter.
- e. **Click Next: Complete the merge** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.

12. **Step 6** – **Notice** the choices on the **Complete the merge** prompt.

- a. **Click** on the **Edit individuals letters** choice.
- b. This will open a **Merge to New Document** dialogue which allow us to merge all our records into a specific new document, separate and apart from the merge letter.docx, rather than just printing the letters out, so that in future we can have a record of to whom we sent letters. **Click OK**.

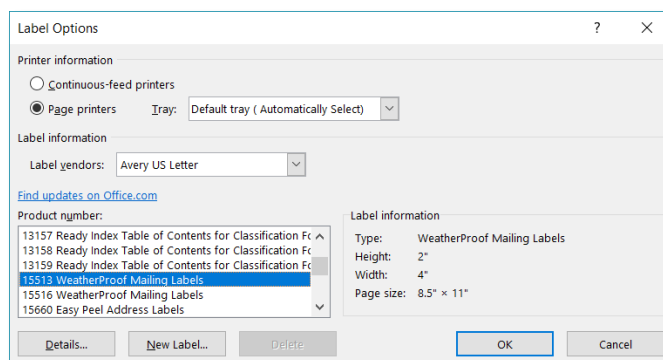




- c. A **new document** called “Letters1” opens with each letter on a separate page.
- d. **Scroll down** the document to see the other pages.
- e. **Save** your file as **Fall Thank You Letters**. **Close** the file.
- f. **Click Print** in the Mail Merge pane. The **Merge to Printer** dialogue box will open allowing you to select which records you wish to print letter for. Be warned: This option sends the records **directly to the printer without showing you a print preview**.
- g. We will not be printing. **Click Cancel**.
- h. **Close** Word. Do not save changes to merge letter.docx.

Steps to Use Mail Merge for Address Labels

1. To save time, we will use **Donations List.xlsx** again.
2. **Open** a new Word document
3. **Click** the **Mailings** tab.
4. **Find** the **Start Mail Merge** group. **Click Start Mail Merge** to **open** the menu and then **click Step-by-Step Mail Merge Wizard**.
5. A Mail Merge pane will open on the right that will take you through the mail merge process in 6 steps.
6. **Step 1** - **Notice Select document type** prompt. By default, the radio button for letters is checked, **check** the radio button next to **Labels**. **Click** on **Next: Starting Document** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
7. **Step 2** - **Notice** the **Select starting document** prompt. Accept the default selection of Change document layout. **Click Label Options**.
 - a. A dialogue box will open allowing you to select the type of printer (dot matrix or laser), the type of label product (such as Avery), and the product number.
 - b. **Click Avery US Letter** and product number **15513** for this lesson.
 - c. **Click OK**. (If you are using a custom label, click **Details**, and then type the size of the label.)

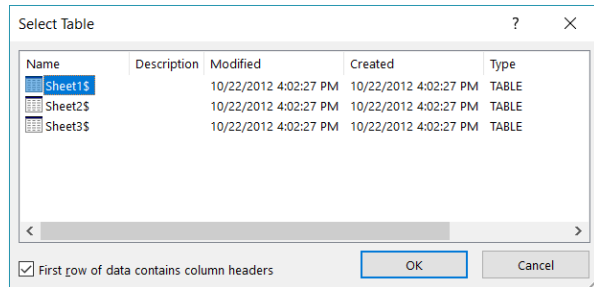


- d. **Click** on **Next: Select Recipients** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.

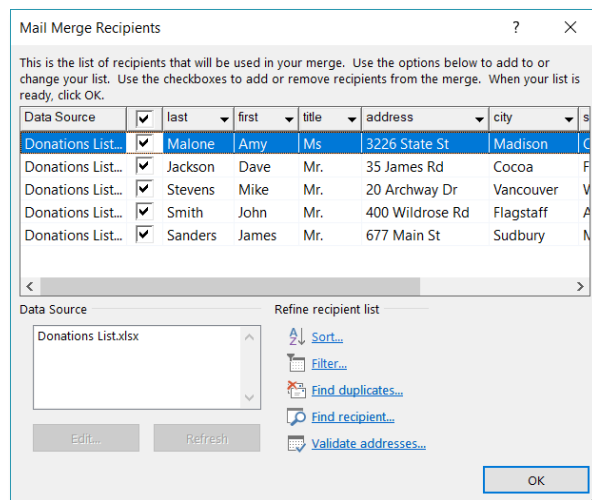


8. **Step 3** – **Notice** the **Select recipients** prompt

- The default selection, Use an existing list is the one we need. To find the list, **click Browse**.
- A **Select Data Source** dialogue box will open. **Navigate** to your flash drive and **open** DonationsList.xlsx
- A **Select Table** dialogue box will open. We need to provide some information about our document. **Notice** that by default, Sheet 1 is selected. **Remember** that when we examined our Excel file our data was on the Worksheet entitled Sheet 1. Also **be sure** that the **check box** before First row of data contains column headers is selected. Click OK.



- A **Mail Merge Recipients** dialogue box will open which will allow you to review, delete or change your list. Since we are not making any changes, **click OK**.



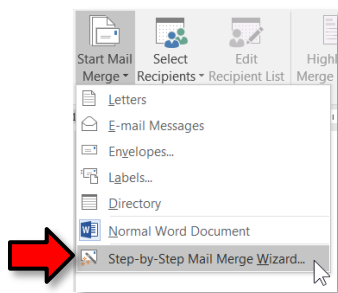
- You will now see that the first label is blank and every other label has «**Next Record**». This is because the first label begins on the first record. The other labels must be instructed to move on to the next record.
- Click Next: Arrange your labels** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane



9. **Step 4** – **Notice** the **Arrange your labels** prompt
 - a. **Scroll** to the **left** and **notice** the insertion point is in the first label.
 - b. Since these are address labels, **click Address block**.
 - c. An insert address block dialogue box will appear allowing you to make the same kinds of choices as is the merge letter above. **Click OK**.
 - d. **Notice** how «Address» gets inserted into only the **first label**.
 - e. Under the **Replicate labels** prompt, **click Update all labels**. This causes the address block to propagate into the other labels.
 - f. **Click Next: Preview your labels** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane
10. **Step 5** – **Notice** the **Preview your labels** prompt
 - a. **Check** your labels
 - b. **Click Next: Complete the merge** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
11. **Step 6** – **Notice** the choices on the **Complete the merge** prompt.
 - a. The same options apply as for Merge letters above.

Steps to Use Mail Merge for Envelopes

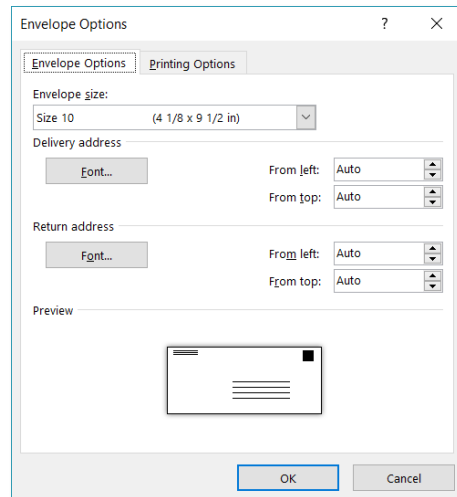
1. To save time, we will use **Donations List.xlsx** again.
2. **Open** a new Word document
3. On the **ribbon**, **click** on the **Mailings** tab.
4. **Find** the **Start Mail Merge** group. **Click Start Mail Merge** to **open** the menu and then **click Step-by-Step Mail Merge Wizard**.



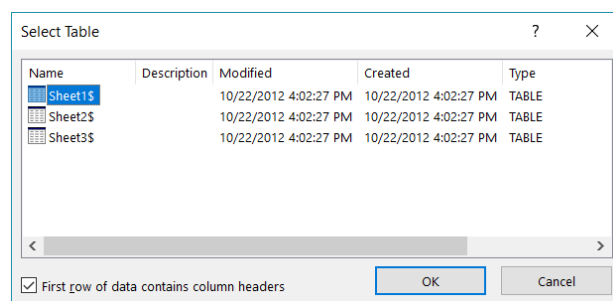
5. A Mail Merge pane will open on the right that will take you through the mail merge process in 6 steps.
6. **Step 1** - **Notice Select document type** prompt. By default, the radio button for letters is checked, **check** the radio button next to Envelopes. **Click** on **Next: Starting Document** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.



7. **Step 2** - **Notice** the **Select starting document** prompt. **Accept** the default selection of Change document layout. **Click** on **Envelope Options**.
- a. A dialogue box will open allowing you to select the envelope size, the type of font and position. **Select Size 10** (the default setting) for this lesson. **Click OK**.

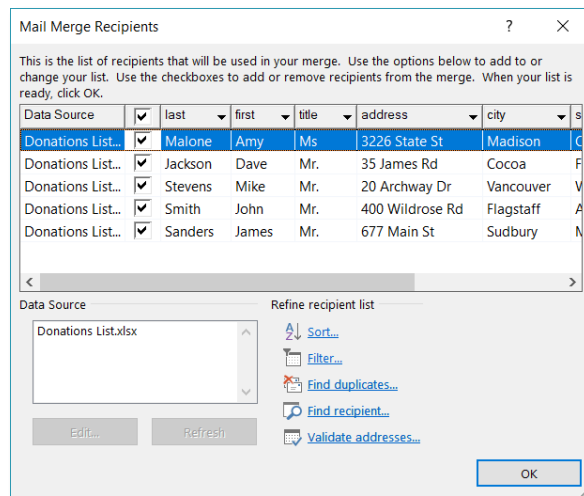


- b. **Click** on **Next: Select Recipients** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
8. **Step 3** – **Notice** the **Select recipients** prompt
- a. The default selection, **Use an existing list** is the one we need. To find the list, **click Browse**.
- b. A **Select Data Source** dialogue box will open. **Navigate** to your flash drive and **open Donations List.xlsx**
- c. A **Select Table** dialogue box will open. We need to provide some information about our document. **Notice** that by default, Sheet 1 is selected. **Remember** that when we examined our Excel file our data was on the Worksheet entitled Sheet 1. Also **be sure** that the **check box** before First row of data contains column headers is *selected*. **Click OK**.

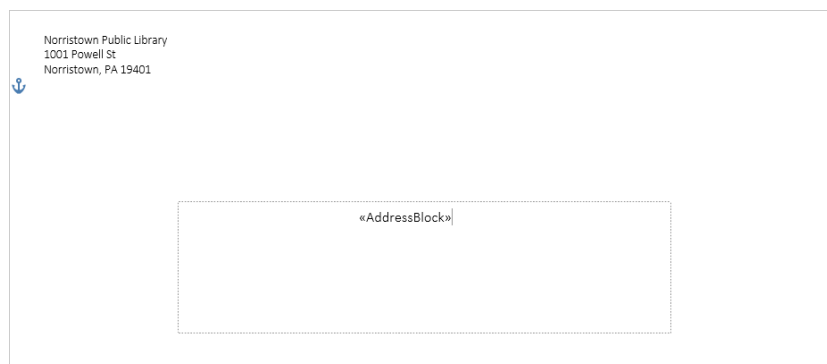




- j. A **Mail Merge Recipients** dialogue box will open which will allow you to review, delete or change your list. Since we are not making any changes, **click OK**.



- d. **Click** on **Next: Arrange Your Envelope** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
9. **Step 4** – **Notice** the **Arrange your Envelope** prompt
- The insertion point will be located where a return address should be placed. Most businesses will have preprinted envelopes. If yours do not, **type** your **return address**.
 - Click around** in the center of the envelope towards the bottom until a **text box** appears.
 - Click Address block** in the Mail Merge pane.
 - An insert address block dialogue box will appear allowing you to make the same kinds of choices as in the merge letter above. **Click OK**.
 - Click Next: Preview your envelopes** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.



10. **Step 5** – **Notice** the **Preview your envelopes** prompt
- Check** your envelopes.
 - Click Next: Complete the merge** at the bottom of the Mail Merge pane.
11. **Step 6** – **Notice** the choices on the **Complete the merge** prompt.
- The same options apply as for Merge letters above